

MICHAEL LYNN

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Product-Minded Builder · AI & Developer Platforms

SUMMARY

Product-minded builder who ships real software: AI tools, autonomous agents, developer platforms, and full products, and measures success by business impact: revenue, adoption, and developer productivity. 25+ years spanning hands-on engineering, enterprise infrastructure, and developer relations, with deep credibility among senior technical leaders in financial services and regulated industries. Equally at home building 0-to-1 and earning trust in the C-suite.

SELECTED BUILDS

- **LightningHire** - AI-powered hiring platform with automated candidate evaluation. Next.js 15, MongoDB, NextAuth v5, Anthropic SDK; GPT-facing backend adapter and Chrome extension.
[LIGHTNINGHIRE.COM](https://lightninghire.com)
- **VAI** - Desktop AI development tool / autonomous-agent platform. MCP tool specifications for code search, marketplace workflow templates, Electron-based packaging.
[VAICLI.COM](https://vaicli.com)
- **Northwind Outfitters** - A fictitious retailer designed to teach and enable developers about the Claude / Anthropic API.
[NORTHWIND.MLYNN.DEV](https://northwind.mlynn.dev) | [TRIAGE.MLYNN.DEV](https://triage.mlynn.dev)
- **The MongoDB Podcast** - creator and host, 160+ episodes on developer tooling and applied AI.

EXPERIENCE

SpaceXAI - AI Adoption Engineer

Aug 2026–Present

Help large engineering organizations make AI coding adoption real, designing and running hackathons, Customer Developer Days, and hands-on workshops that give developers a reason to change how they work.

- Partner with AI Deployment Managers and Customer Success to identify where adoption is stuck, then build the right intervention for that account.
- Create repeatable event playbooks, agendas, judging rubrics, and retrospectives; troubleshoot with developers in real time.
- Turn engagement outcomes into practical lessons for account teams and Customer Education. The goal is not attendance. It is sustained change in how teams build software with AI.

Cursor - AI Adoption Engineer

May 2026-Aug 2026

Lead AI adoption and developer enablement across Cursor's top-100 enterprise accounts (financial services, healthcare, retail).

- Designed and delivered a CLI-first Claude Code → Cursor migration program for a large derivatives-trading firm, with live terminal demos, skills, rules, and MCP.
- Built reusable enablement assets adopted by the field: an internal deck-generation tool with early ADM adoption, a standardized 101/201 curriculum with embedded facilitator guides, and a hackathon-in-a-box program.
- Designed a tiered "champion" framework to drive durable, self-sustaining adoption across accounts.
- Partnered with FE, ADM, and SA teams to standardize how Cursor is positioned and deployed at scale.

MongoDB - Remote / Philadelphia

Jan 2016-May 2026 · 11 years

Principal Staff Developer Advocate; Manager, Strategic Developer Relations

Mar 2018-May 2026

Led strategic developer engagement for MongoDB's priority enterprise accounts and its global developer-advocacy organization.

- Built open-source tooling adopted by developers implementing retrieval-augmented systems on MongoDB Vector Search.
- Provided hands-on technical contributions, guiding engineering teams through production deployment of RAG-based systems.
- Designed and delivered Developer Day programs used globally to drive hands-on product adoption and usage growth.
- Developed repeatable AI enablement playbooks for secure, compliant environments including HIPAA workloads.
- Led architecture sessions integrating AI workflows into existing SDLC pipelines for performance, scalability, and security.
- Built trusted-advisor relationships with VP Engineering and CTO stakeholders, aligning platform adoption with business objectives.
- Translated structured customer feedback into product-roadmap influence across AI and search capabilities.
- Set strategy for global developer engagement, content, and community growth.

Sr. Solutions Architect

Jan 2016-Mar 2018

Owned technical pre-sales and solutions architecture for MongoDB's enterprise prospects and priority accounts.

- Built and led a technical enablement program, creating the content and teaching incoming Sales, Account Managers, and Solutions Architects, with major, measurable impact on sales and pre-sales cycles.
- Designed reference architectures and hands-on workshops that shortened evaluation-to-adoption for enterprise prospects.
- Served as trusted technical advisor through complex evaluations, POCs, and production deployments.

Medallia - Solutions Consultant; Business Development Solutions Consultant

Jun 2013–Dec 2015

- Drove technical pre-sales, customer solution design, and enterprise deployments as a Solutions Consultant.
- Partnered with sales and product teams to align technical solutions with customer outcomes and accelerate evaluations.

BMC Software - Pre-Sales Software Consulting Manager; Senior Software Consultant

Jan 2011–Jul 2013

- Player-coach manager leading a team of pre-sales software consultants supporting the enterprise sales and account-management teams (2012–2013).
- Explained, demonstrated, and proved the value of server automation and cloud computing to bridge the gap between business and IT (2011–2012).

TD Ameritrade - Engineer Consultant

Apr 2010–Jan 2011

- Built an automated firmware/BIOS update utility on PXE/TFTP, improving the efficiency of hardware firmware deployment.
- Built a suite of Bash/Perl tools for server inventory data capture and analysis in support of SAS70 and other audit requirements.
- Led proof of concept and vendor evaluation for IP Address Management (IPAM), creating the evaluation framework behind the product decision.
- Owned external DNS maintenance for all TD Ameritrade and affiliated brands; assisted in a large-scale, multi-phase data center migration.

Bank of America - Engineering Manager

Oct 2006–Apr 2010

- Led a team of engineers responsible for system design: hardware, software, infrastructure components, interfaces, scalability, and availability solutions meeting business requirements.
- Owned application and infrastructure integration, and third-level support: incident troubleshooting, analysis, resolution, and documentation beyond first- and second-level operations.
- Built the Server Visibility Tool for inventory and maintenance of a 2,500-server estate (ExtJS/JavaScript/PHP front end, Perl collectors, MySQL).
- Served as division lead for UNIX/Linux platform issues in a data center migration.

Merrill Lynch - Vice President, Head of UNIX Engineering

Mar 1997–Oct 2006 · 9 years

- **VP, Head of UNIX Engineering** (2000–2006): owned UNIX/Linux OS and hardware standards, set platform roadmaps and strategic direction, and managed the engineering team maintaining those standards.
- **VP, Manager of Internet Support Services** (1998–2000): ran production implementation and maintenance of the firm's internet and intranet infrastructure, set server configuration and sizing guidelines, and managed a team of systems administrators.

- **Systems Administrator** (1997–1998): built and administered the Merrill Lynch Research web site and its multi-server production environment.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Built and shipped multiple products end-to-end, from AI hiring platforms to autonomous-agent frameworks and developer tooling.
- Delivered hands-on enablement programs reaching thousands of developers globally.
- Built technical-enablement programs that measurably accelerated sales and pre-sales cycles across a global go-to-market org.
- Influenced product roadmap through structured enterprise feedback loops.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

BUILD & AI	JavaScript, Node.js, Python, React, Next.js, REST APIs, Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agent workflows, LLM integration, prompt engineering, retrieval-augmented generation, embedding models, semantic search
DATA & PLATFORMS	MongoDB Atlas, Vector Search, Atlas Search, Queryable Encryption, Aggregation Pipelines, Change Streams, Data Federation
INFRASTRUCTURE & DEVOPS	Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, GCP, Azure, UNIX/Linux systems engineering
DEVELOPER PRODUCTIVITY	AI-assisted development workflows, enterprise rollout strategy, workshop facilitation, executive technical briefings

SPEAKING & PUBLICATIONS

- Speaker at AWS re:Invent and MongoDB.local on AI and data-platform evolution.
- Founder and leader of MongoDB User Groups; frequent presenter at enterprise workshops.
- Creator and co-host of The MongoDB Podcast, 160+ episodes on developer tooling and applied AI.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Pennco Technical Institute, Associate Degree in Specialized Technology, Computer Programming 1984–1987

CERTIFICATIONS	Red Hat Certified Engineer. MongoDB Skill certifications: Relational to Document Model; Schema Patterns and Anti-patterns; Schema Design Optimization; Vector Search Fundamentals; RAG with MongoDB; Secure MongoDB Atlas: AuthN and AuthZ; Secure MongoDB Self-Managed: AuthN & AuthZ; Networking Security: Atlas.
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Ongoing professional development in artificial intelligence, machine learning, and modern application architecture.